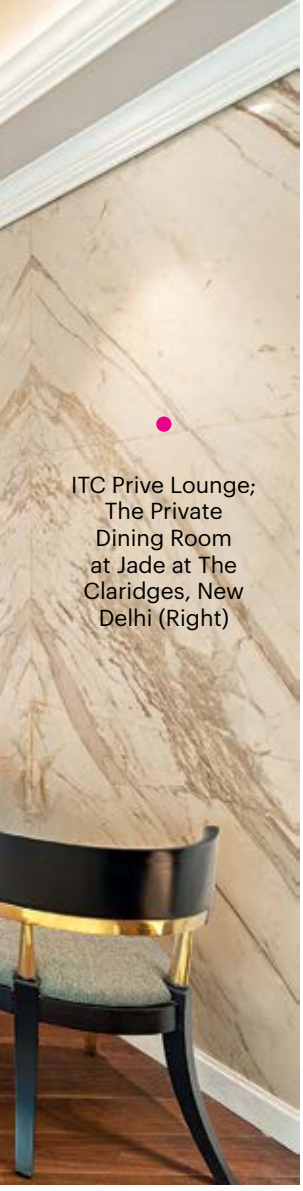


ITC Prive Lounge; The Private Dining Room at Jade at The Claridges, New Delhi (Right)



envelope. This is not incidental; it is constitutional.

Intellectual & cultural nourishment. The best modern clubs are not social venues with a side of programming. They are cultural institutions with a social wrapper: A film screening followed by a conversation with the director; a whisky tasting led by a master distiller. It's not just relaxation alone, but stimulation that drives numbers.

Identity. In a world where status is increasingly visible but meaning, just as elusive, the new generation of clubs has, almost unanimously, rejected the legacy model. They have built around values: Creativity, sustainability, intellectual ambition, connoisseurship rather than around wealth alone.

CLUBS DEFINING THE NEW INDIA

A new geography of belonging is emerging across India's metros with each club choosing its own philosophy, aesthetic, and version of the ideal member.

ARQ
The Leela Palace, New Delhi

Arq, The Leela Palace New Delhi's members-only enclave, takes the peacock—India's national bird — as its central motif, translated into teal embroidered walls, sodalite-stone tables and K9 crystal chandeliers. Members can retreat into a reading room of more than 350 books, host a board meeting in the morning, and find their way by evening into a single-malt-driven social hour; an intimate ten-seat private dining room, styled after Versace, adds a further register of exclusivity, and members carry their privileges through into the Palace's two-level Spa by ESPA—an active floor with its own fitness studio, sauna and steam room, and a passive floor of Ayurvedic-inspired treatment suites as well as the rooftop infinity pool. Approvals are personally overseen by the Leela's leadership—proof, as the club puts it, that membership reflects sensibility as much as status.
Membership costs Upwards of ₹45 lakh per year

THE CHAMBERS
Taj, New Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai and now London & Dubai

Launched in 1975 and recently reimagined, The Chambers remains India's most internationally connected private club, now spanning six